

How to choose the right tracking plan template (Mixpanel, Amplitude, and more)

An overview of all the templates out there.



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March 31, 2021

7 min read

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A few vendors have already created their own templates to use when getting started with a tracking plan. These templates allow you to reduce the headaches involved in creating a tracking plan from scratch and what's great about using templates is the ability to choose one based on your industry.

However, static tracking plan templates do have their limitations. There is no way to enforce that what's in the plan is actually in the product, often leading to a mis-match between the events and properties you see in your tracking plan and what is actually instrumented (we talk more about the limitations of static tracking plan templates below).

Determine what you need to track

Tracking plans are like shoes. They come in different sizes yet serve the same purpose 🧦. They should be unique to your business and help you answer questions about what you are trying to achieve for your organization.

A good tracking plan will answer these three questions:

- What are the metrics we care about as a company?
- What data is needed to answer those metrics?
- How should I structure my data to easily answer those metrics?
- Bonus: How can I ensure the data being captured is trustworthy?

When putting together a tracking plan, it is best to start with listing your goals, followed by outlining your metrics and determining what events and properties you need to report on that metric properly. If your goals, metrics, and events are not aligned, you'll likely end up tracking data not necessary to your business and missing out on events that are crucial to your organization.

To learn more about creating a tracking plan, refer to these two previous posts we have published, where we cover [how to create a tracking plan](#) for your organization and [best practices to follow when creating or evolving your analytics tracking](#).

Pick the right tracking plan template based on your needs

There are plenty of tracking plan templates out there, and some of them are designed toward specific industries. Before examining the different templates, let's break down what to look out for and what to customize with your tracking plan template.

What to look out for:

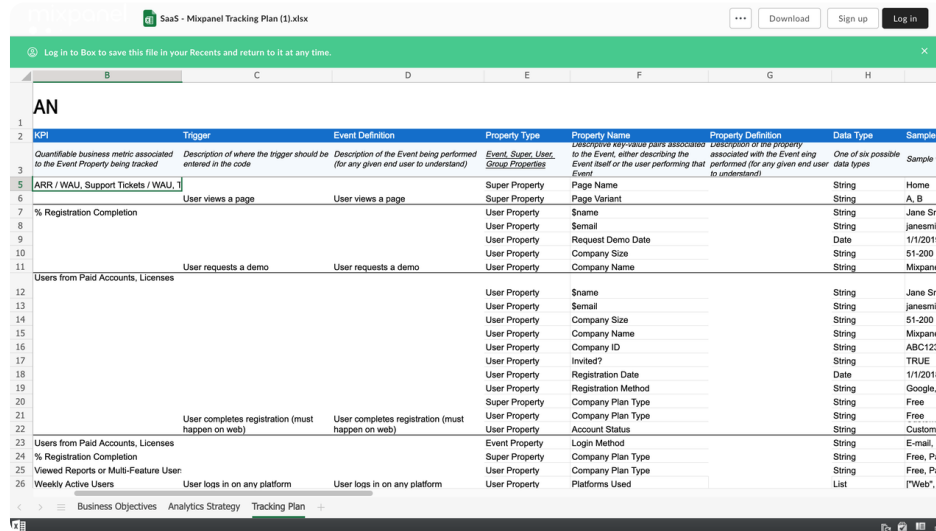
- A tab that contains overall business objectives and key performance indicators (KPIs)
- Column must-haves are event name, description, property name, property type, source, version, owner, platform, side (client or server), priority level, and code snippet.
- Sample data that can help you figure what to start with.
- Detailed instructions on how to get started with that tracking plan.
- Question-forming guidelines that help your team when asking questions about your users/products. We like this example from [Amplitude](#): For users that favorited artists during sign-up, how many of those engaged with the favorite artist's playlist?

What to customize:

- Events, descriptions, sources, and properties that align with your overall KPIs. It would be best if you made these as detailed as possible.
- Your overall business objectives to help your team stay on track.

If you're a SaaS business

This SaaS [Mixpanel tracking plan template](#) is broken down into three sheets—one for your business objectives, one for your analytics strategy, and your tracking plan. If you are just getting started with creating a tracking plan, this is a great place to start, but note that, over time, your tracking plan could be too hard to manage this way.



The screenshot shows a spreadsheet titled "SaaS - Mixpanel Tracking Plan (1).xlsx". The spreadsheet is organized into columns: KPI, Trigger, Event Definition, Property Type, Property Name, Property Definition, Data Type, and Sample. The rows are numbered 1 through 26. The first row (row 1) is a header row. The second row (row 2) is a sub-header row. The third row (row 3) is a sub-header row. The fourth row (row 4) is a sub-header row. The fifth row (row 5) is a sub-header row. The sixth row (row 6) is a sub-header row. The seventh row (row 7) is a sub-header row. The eighth row (row 8) is a sub-header row. The ninth row (row 9) is a sub-header row. The tenth row (row 10) is a sub-header row. The eleventh row (row 11) is a sub-header row. The twelfth row (row 12) is a sub-header row. The thirteenth row (row 13) is a sub-header row. The fourteenth row (row 14) is a sub-header row. The fifteenth row (row 15) is a sub-header row. The sixteenth row (row 16) is a sub-header row. The seventeenth row (row 17) is a sub-header row. The eighteenth row (row 18) is a sub-header row. The nineteenth row (row 19) is a sub-header row. The twentieth row (row 20) is a sub-header row. The twenty-first row (row 21) is a sub-header row. The twenty-second row (row 22) is a sub-header row. The twenty-third row (row 23) is a sub-header row. The twenty-fourth row (row 24) is a sub-header row. The twenty-fifth row (row 25) is a sub-header row. The twenty-sixth row (row 26) is a sub-header row.

[Segment](#) has a [great template](#) for companies in the SaaS industry as well. The template allows you to describe the event, align properties to that event, and even select the priority level to the organization. This template works best if you are already using Segment as your customer data platform.

[Segment](#) has a great [e-commerce template](#) as well. Like the others, their template is easy to use and works best if you are already using Segment as your customer data

Tracking plan templates for any industry

[Segment](#) has a multifunctional [tracking plan for a variety of industries](#). This easy-to-use template keeps track of events, user IDs, and even implementation notes.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1							
2							
3							
4							
5							
6							
7							
8							
9							
10							

[Amplitude](#) put together a basic tracking plan [template](#) that can apply to a variety of industries. What is nice about this tracking plan is the use-case tab that helps you answer business questions and put together a well-formed question.

AI/CI

Use Case Tracker

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Use Case Tracker			Add Question		
	Are all of your questions able to be answered by the events you are tracking?					
2	Use Case	Business Questions for Amplitude	In Taxonomy?	Validated?	Chart Links	
3			No	No		
4			No	No		
5			No	No		
6			No	No		
7			No	No		
8			No	No		
9			No	No		
10			No	No		
11			No	No		
12			No	No		
13			No	No		
14			No	No		
15			No	No		
16			No	No		
17			No	No		
18						
19	Question forming guidelines. A well-formed question to ask is...					
20	Quantitatively Oriented:	Incorporates:	Examples			
21	How many....	Metric of interest: Conversion, Retention, etc.	What % of users are seeing an error on identity verification? >>> Does that affect retention?			
22	How often....	User cohort: Users who did "X" ; User who saw "Y" ; Web vs. Mobile ; etc.	For users that favorited artists in sign-up, how many of those engage with the F			

Use Cases -

Product Flows (optional) -

Events -

Users -

Accounts -

Sheet3 -

Taxonomy Best Practices

<

Mixpanel has a blank tracking plan that you can access [here](#) if you want to create one

1. **Hard to keep up to date:** Since they don't live alongside your workflow, the

2. **Hard to version:** Tracking plans can become very complex and hard to manage as more people get involved. With more people involved, the list of potential problems grows, such as someone overwriting another user's changes. **Note:** Iteratively makes [versioning](#) as easy as it is in Git 🧐.
3. **There is no way to enforce that what's in the plan is actually in the product:**
This situation happens quite often, and it might even sound familiar. This problem occurs when there is a lack of culture around analytics tracking, and it is pushed aside. **Note:** Iteratively helps you ditch your static tracking plan by enforcing the schema in code, ensuring it is not ignored by developers.

Start tracking with Iteratively today

Tracking plan templates are a great place to get started if you are new to implementing tracking plans. However, this does not solve the problem of making a tracking plan part of the developer workflow. That's why we built [Iteratively](#) – to help data teams, product managers, and engineers define, instrument, and collaborate on their analytics tracking.

Iteratively creates a single source of truth for your analytics, ensuring that data consumers trust the information. We empower product managers to take ownership of their tracking plan. Try out Iteratively for your company by [creating an account](#) or [booking a demo](#) with one of our team members to learn more.

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